Presentate: Structured Themes Manual

A guide for hierarchy-aware themes

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1 Introduction

Presentate provides two categories of themes:

1. **Basic Layouts**: Minimalist themes like `simple` and `default` that focus on content without managing complex document hierarchy.
2. **Structured Themes**: A suite of themes (`sidebar`, `miniframes`, `split`, `progressive-outline`, and `minimal`) designed to automatically handle document structure, navigation, and transitions.

This manual focuses exclusively on the Structured Themes category. These themes share a common core API and a **Unified Transition Engine** to generate roadmap slides between content blocks.

2 Global Configuration for Structured Themes

All structured themes follow a consistent API pattern and are located in the `themes.structured` namespace. They are invoked using a `template` function through a show rule.

```
#import "@preview/presentate:0.3.1": themes
#show: themes.structured.sidebar.template.with(
  title: [My Presentation],
  author: [John Doe],
  // ... options
)
```

2.1 Common Parameters

The following parameters are supported by all five structured themes:

Parameter	Type	Description
`title`	content	The main title displayed on the title slide and often in the navigation bar.
`subtitle`	content	Displayed below the title on the title slide (optional).
`author`	content	The name of the presenter.
`date`	content	Presentation date. Defaults to current date.
`text-font`	string	Font family family for the whole document. Default: “Lato”.
`text-size`	length	Base text size. Default: `20pt`.
`mapping`	dictionary	Maps logical roles to Typst heading levels. Default: `(section: 1, subsection: 2)`. Supports `part`, `section`, `subsection`.
`auto-title`	bool	If `true`, slides without a manual title will automatically display the current heading body. Default: `false`.
`max-length`	dict | none	Allows truncating titles in navigation bars per level. Example: `(level-1: 15, level-2: 10)`. Default: `none`.
`use-short-title`	bool	If `true`, themes will prioritize alternative titles defined via the `<short>` label for navigation components. Default: `false`.
`show-heading-numbering`	bool	Global toggle for heading numbering. Default: `true`.
`numbering-format`	str | auto	Typst numbering format string (e.g., `"1.1"`, `"I.a"`). If set to `auto`, it respects the global `#set heading(numbering: ...)` setting. Default: `auto`.
`show-outline`	bool	If `true`, displays an outline slide after the title slide. Default: `false`.

Parameter	Type	Description
`outline-title`	content	The title of the automatic outline slide. Default: `[Outline]`.
`outline-depth`	int	The maximum depth of headings shown in the outline slide. Default: `2`.
`show-all-sections-in-transition`	bool	If `true`, displays the full presentation outline during roadmap slides. Default: `false`.
`transitions`	dictionary	Configuration for the transition engine (see Section 3).

2.2 Structural Mapping

The `mapping` dictionary is crucial as it tells the theme which headings should trigger transitions and navigation updates.

- `part`: Typically mapped to level 1 (=).
- `section`: Typically mapped to level 1 or 2.
- `subsection`: Typically mapped to level 2 or 3.

Example:

```
mapping: (part: 1, section: 2, subsection: 3)
```

2.3 Important Note: Heading Placement

To ensure that transitions and navigation work correctly, structural headings (=, ==, etc.) must always be placed at the **top level** of your document.

Do not place these headings inside a `#slide[...]` block. Headings nested inside slides will not trigger transitions and will cause the compilation to fail.

2.4 Navigation and Long Titles

To handle complex document structures in limited space (like sidebars or breadcrumbs), Presentate offers two complementary mechanisms:

2.4.1 Short Titles (Labels)

You can define an alternative short title for any heading by placing a `#metadata` block with the `<short>` label immediately after the heading.

```
= This is a very long section title that might overflow
#metadata("Short Title") <short>
```

When `use-short-title: true` is enabled in the template configuration, navigation components will automatically use “Short Title” instead of the full heading body.

2.4.2 Automatic Truncation

The `max-length` parameter allows you to enforce a character limit on navigation items. If a title exceeds the specified length, it will be truncated with an ellipsis (...).

```
max-length: (level-1: 15, level-2: 10)
```

3 The Unified Transition Engine

The transition engine automatically generates roadmap slides when your structure changes. It is highly configurable via the `transitions` argument.

3.1 Configuration Options

The `transitions` dictionary accepts the following keys:

Key	Type	Description
`enabled`	bool	Global switch for transitions. Default: `true`.
`max-level`	int	The maximum Typst heading level (1-3) that triggers a transition. Default: `3`.
`show-numbering`	bool	Display heading numbers in transition outlines using the global `numbering-format`. Default: `true`.
`background`	color | str	Background of transition slides. `"theme"` (primary color), `"none"` (white), or an explicit color.
`filter`	function	A callback `(heading) => bool`. Headings returning `false` will not trigger slides and will be hidden from outlines.
`style`	dictionary	Global styling for the transition outline (see below).
`parts`	dictionary	Override settings for Part transitions. Accepts `enabled` (bool), `visibility` (dict), and `background` (color|str).
`sections`	dictionary	Override settings for Section transitions. Accepts `enabled` (bool), `visibility` (dict), and `background` (color|str).
`subsections`	dictionary	Override settings for Subsection transitions. Accepts `enabled` (bool), `visibility` (dict), and `background` (color|str).

3.2 Transition Style

The `transitions.style` dictionary controls the typography of the roadmap:

- `active-color`: Color of the current heading. Defaults to theme accent.
- `active-weight`: Font weight of the active heading. Default: `"bold"`.
- `inactive-opacity`: Opacity (0.0 to 1.0) for future headings. Default: `0.3`.
- `completed-opacity`: Opacity for past headings. Default: `0.6`.

3.3 Visibility Logic

For each roadmap type (`parts`, `sections`, `subsections`), you can define which levels are visible via the `visibility` key:

- `"all"`: Show all headings at this level.
- `"current"`: Only show the active heading at this level.
- `"current-parent"`: Show siblings of the active heading (e.g., all subsections of the current section).
- `"none"`: Hide this level.

Default Behavior:

- Part transitions: Show all Parts, hide Sections/Subsections.
- Section transitions: Show current Part, all Sections, current Subsections.

4 Theme Reference

4.1 Sidebar Theme

The `sidebar` theme provides a persistent navigation bar on the left or right side. It now automatically displays the presentation title at the top of the bar for better branding.

4.1.1 Theme Parameters

`side`	string	`"left"` or `"right"`. Default: `"left"`.
`width`	ratio	Width of the sidebar. Default: `22%`.
`sidebar-color`	color	Background color of the sidebar.
`main-color`	color	Background color of the content area. Default: `white`.
`active-color`	color	Highlight color for the current item in the sidebar.
`logo`	content	An image or shape to display in the sidebar above the title.
`logo-position`	string	`"top"` or `"bottom"`. Default: `"top"`.
`outline-options`	dictionary	See “Outline Configuration” below. Customizes visibility, spacing, and styling.

4.1.1.1 Outline Configuration

The `outline-options` dictionary allows fine-grained control over the sidebar navigation menu. It merges with the theme defaults to customize the `progressive-outline` component.

`level-{n}-mode`	Visibility for level `n` (1-3). Options: `"all"`, `"current"`, `"current-parent"`, `"none"`.
`spacing`	Dictionary for layout. Keys include `indent-{n}` (e.g., `indent-2`) and `v-between-{prev}-{curr}` (e.g., `v-between-1-2`) defining vertical gaps between specific level transitions.
`text-styles`	Dictionary defining font styles. Keys: `level-{n}` containing sub-keys `active`, `inactive`, `completed` (each accepting text parameters like `fill`, `weight`).
`match-page-only`	Bool. If `true` (default), the outline highlights only the heading exactly on the current page. If `false`, it maintains the highlight on the current logical section even on subsequent slides.

4.2 Miniframes Theme

Inspired by the Beamer Berlin theme, it uses dots to show progress within sections. It features a specific separator `|` when three levels of hierarchy are used. It fully supports `max-length` truncation and `<short>` titles for its section names.

4.2.1 Navigation Dictionary

The `navigation` parameter is a dictionary containing:

`position`	string	`"top"` or `"bottom"`. Default: `"top"`.
`style`	string	`"compact"` (one row) or `"grid"` (one row per subsection).
`marker-shape`	string	`"circle"` or `"square"`.
`marker-size`	length	Size of the dots. Default: `4pt`.
`fill`	color	Color of the navigation bar block.
`show-level1-titles`	bool	Show names of sections in the bar. Default: `true`.

4.3 Split Theme

Features a horizontal header divided into two contrasting areas for Section and Subsection titles. It also supports `max-length` and `<short>` titles for both blocks.

4.3.1 Theme Parameters

`primary`	color	Background color for the Section block.
`secondary`	color	Background color for the Subsection block.
`navigation-style`	string	`"all"` (show all siblings) or `"current"`.
`header-columns`	tuple	Width ratios for the header blocks. Default: `(1fr, 1fr)`.
`section-align`	alignment	Horizontal alignment for section text. Default: `right`.

4.4 Progressive Outline Theme

A clean theme focused on document progression with a breadcrumb-style header. It supports dynamic fil-d'ariane based on the active `mapping`, and automatically integrates `max-length` and short titles.

4.4.1 Theme Parameters

`header`	content | auto	Override the top breadcrumb navigation.
`footer`	content | auto	Override the bottom page number area.

4.5 Minimal Theme

A content-first theme with zero distractions. It has no persistent headers or sidebars, providing the maximum possible area for your content while still supporting automatic roadmap transitions.

It features a discrete breadcrumb-style navigation in the footer by default, providing a sense of progression without cluttering the slide.

4.5.1 Theme Parameters

`header`	content | none	Optional header content. Default: `none`.
`footer`	content | auto	Optional footer content. Displays a breadcrumb navigation with author and page number by default.

5 Hooks API

If you need to generate a transition slide that doesn't fit the roadmap pattern (e.g., a full-page image), use hooks. They take precedence over the transition engine.

- `on-part-change(heading)`
- `on-section-change(heading)`
- `on-subsection-change(heading)`

Example:

```
#show: template.with(
  on-section-change: (h) => {
    empty-slide(fill: black)[
      #set align(center + horizon)
      #text(white, size: 2em)[Next Chapter: #h.body]
    ]
  }
)
```